Best Lentil Soup

Cumin-spiced vegan lentil soup with greens, partly blended.

SERVES **4 LARGE OR 6 MODEST** · ACTIVE **10 MIN** · TOTAL **55 MIN**

INGREDIENTS

1/4 cup	extra virgin olive oil
1 medium	yellow or white onion, chopped
2	carrots, peeled and chopped
4 cloves	garlic, pressed or minced
2 tsp	ground cumin
1 tsp	curry powder
1/2 tsp	dried thyme
28 oz can	diced tomatoes, lightly drained
1 cup	brown or green lentils, picked over and rinsed
4 cups	vegetable broth
2 cups	water
1 tsp	salt, plus more to taste
pinch	red pepper flakes
	black pepper, freshly ground, to taste
1 cup	collard greens or kale, chopped, tough ribs removed
1 to 2 tbsp	lemon juice (1/2 to 1 medium lemon), to taste

METHOD

1. Heat the oil over medium in a Dutch oven or heavy stainless pot of 5 quarts or more until it shimmers. Add the onion and carrot and cook, stirring often, about **5 minutes**, until the onion is soft and translucent.
2. Add the garlic, cumin, curry powder and thyme and stir constantly about **30 seconds**, just until fragrant; stainless scorches spices fast, so keep stirring. Add the tomatoes and cook a few minutes more, stirring often.
3. Add the lentils, broth, water, 1 tsp salt, the pepper flakes and plenty of black pepper. Bring to a boil, partially cover, and simmer gently **25 to 30 minutes**, until the lentils are tender but still hold their shape.
4. Blend 2 cups of the soup until smooth and stir it back in; this is what makes it creamy without cream. Lock the blender lid and hold a towel over it against the steam. An immersion blender used briefly in the pot works too.
5. Add the greens and simmer **5 minutes** more, until as tender as you like.
6. Off the heat, stir in 1 tbsp lemon juice. Taste and adjust with more salt, pepper or lemon. Serve hot.

NOTES

- Prep everything before you start; the spice step moves fast.
- The 1/4 cup oil is deliberate. It's where the soup's richness comes from, so don't cut it back.
- For more heat, stir in another pinch or two of pepper flakes at the end.
- Keeps about **4 days** in the fridge and tastes better the next day. Freezes for several months; thaw before reheating.

TOASTED SPICE & GHEE
VEGETABLE MAIN · STOVETOP SIMMER

Adapted from Cookie and Kate (Kathryne Taylor), cookieandkate.com/best-lentil-soup-recipe. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.